

PRINCIPLES OF MICROECONOMICS

University of Miami

Fall 2026

Instructor:	Kevin Sterling	Time:	MWF 1:25 PM – 2:15 PM
Email:	kxs3598@miami.edu	Place:	Whitten LC 140
Code:	ECO 211	Section:	F

Office Hours: After class or by appointment.

Teaching Assistants: Sampada Donahalli Dinesh (sxd1666@miami.edu) and Henry Winston (haw67@miami.edu).
Please CC both TAs on all emails to ensure the quickest response.

Course Description: Fundamental course devoted to the development and application of basic analytical tools and principles required for an understanding of major economic problems and policy alternatives available for their solution. A particular emphasis is devoted to microeconomic analysis. Topics include the study of markets under varying conditions of competition, including market deficiencies such as pollution, prices, and resource allocation distribution of income, including poverty problems, the economics of the firm and the government, and international economic relations.

Reference Textbook: The course will cover chapters from the following text:

- Gregory Mankiw, *Introduction to Microeconomics*.
- Additional weekly readings and online resources will be available on Blackboard.

Learning Objectives: This course is primarily designed for students to:

- Understand the fundamental aspects of microeconomics intuitively, graphically, and mathematically.
- Apply microeconomics terminology, methods, and concepts correctly.
- Analyze problems for decision making using economic tools.

Important University Dates:

Aug. 26: Last Day for Registration and to Add a Course
Sept. 2: Last Day to Drop a Course Without a 'W'
Nov. 6: Last Day to Withdraw from Course/Semester

Important Class Dates:

Sept. 11: Problem Set #1
Sept. 18: Midterm #1
Oct. 16: Problem Set #2
Oct. 23: Midterm #2
Nov. 19: Problem Set #3
TBA: Final Exam

Grading Policy: Problem Sets (30%), Midterm 1 (20%), Midterm 2 (20%), Cumulative Final (30%).

Extra Credit: Students may earn up to 7.5% in extra credit by consistently logging their study hours using Clockify throughout the semester. Additional information regarding participation requirements and how extra credit will be awarded will be provided during the course.

Grading Scale:

Final Grade	Raw Score
A+	97–100
A	93–96
A-	90–92
B+	87–89
B	83–86
B-	80–82

Final Grade	Raw Score
C+	77–79
C	73–76
C-	70–72
D+	67–69
D	65–66
F	< 65

Tentative Course Outline:

Week	Dates	Lectures	Textbook Chapters	Problem Sets	Exams
1	Aug. 17, 19, 21	Economic Foundations I			
2	Aug. 24, 26, 28	Economic Foundations II	Ch. 3		
3	Aug. 31, Sep. 2, 4	Supply and Demand	Ch. 4		
4	Sep. 9, 11 Sep. 7 – Labor Day	Equilibrium	Ch.4 & Ch. 7	Problem Set #1	
5	Sep. 14, 16, 18	Elasticity & Exam Week	Ch. 5		Exam #1
6	Sep. 21, 23, 25	Elasticity & Price Ceilings	Ch. 5 & 6		
7	Sep. 28, 30, Oct. 2	Externalities	Ch. 10		
8	Oct. 5, 7, 9	Public Goods and Common Resources	Ch. 11		
9	Oct. 14, 16 Oct. 12 – Fall Recess	Economic Structures		Problem Set #2	
10	Oct. 19, 21, 23	Exam Week			Exam #2
11	Oct. 26, 28, 30	The Costs of Production	Ch. 14		
12	Nov. 2, 4, 6	Perfect Competition	Ch. 15		
13	Nov. 9, 11, 13	Monopoly	Ch. 16		
14	Nov. 16, 18, 20 Nov. 20 – Zoom Class	Oligopoly	Ch. 18		
15	Nov. 23 Nov. 25, 27 – Thanksgiving Break	No class			
16	Nov. 30 Last Class	Summary of Course		Problem Set #3	
17	Dec. 3–9	Final Exams			Final

Reasonable Accommodation: I am committed to providing all students with a fair opportunity to succeed in this course. If circumstances arise that may affect your ability to meet course requirements, please contact me as early as possible. We can work together to identify appropriate strategies that support your needs while maintaining the academic standards and learning objectives of the course.

Late Assignments, Missed Classes, and Missed Examinations Policy:

Problem sets are due on the assigned date at the start of the class, and students will generally have approximately one week to complete each assignment. If illness, injury, or another extenuating circumstance prevents a student from attending class, completing an assignment on time, or taking an examination as scheduled, the student should contact me as soon as reasonably possible to discuss appropriate arrangements. Extensions and make-up examinations will be considered only when the request is timely, reasonable, and supported by appropriate documentation, such as documentation from a physician, coach, or the [Student Health Service](#).

Academic Honesty:

Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity in all work completed for this course. Suspected violations, such as cheating, plagiarism and other forms of academic dishonesty, will be referred to the University of Miami and Miami Herbert Business School.

Religious Holy Days Policy: University of Miami policy:

Any student absent from class in observance of a religious holy day shall not be penalized in any way for an examination or assignment missed during the period of absence. Absence in observance of a religious holy day does not relieve students from responsibility for any part of the course work required during the period of absence. Students who are absent on days of examinations or class assignments shall be offered a reasonable opportunity to make up the work without penalty, if the student previously arranged to be absent. Nothing in this policy shall preclude faculty members from limiting the number of student absences to a reasonable number of absences for any reason. The faculty member has discretion to determine how the make-up obligation will be fulfilled. A faculty member who penalizes a student contrary to these provisions may have committed unprofessional conduct, and thus may be subject to a complaint to the Committee on Professional Conduct under the provisions of Section B4.9 of the Faculty Manual.

It is the student's obligation to provide faculty members with notice of the dates they will be absent due to observance of religious holy days, preferably before the beginning of classes but no later than the end of the first three class days. For religious holy days that fall within the first three class days, students must provide faculty members with notice no later than two class days before the absence. Missing a class due to travel plans associated with a particular religious holy day does not constitute an excused absence. Absences due to observance of religious holy days that are not pre-arranged with the relevant faculty member within the first three class days may be considered unexcused, and the faculty member may therefore prevent the student from making up examinations or assignments missed during the period of absence.

Guidelines Regarding the use of AI:

Large language models may be useful tools for enhancing learning, productivity, and creativity. Artificial intelligence tools can be useful aids for learning, and their use in this course is not prohibited. However, students should use these tools at their own peril. The purpose of a university education is not simply to produce correct answers, but to develop the ability to think critically, solve problems, communicate ideas, work independently and collaboratively. When you outsource these tasks to AI, you also outsource the opportunity to develop those skills.

AI will increasingly be part of the workplace. Your value in that environment will depend not on your ability to obtain an answer from AI, but on what you can understand, evaluate, and contribute beyond what AI can produce on its own. You are therefore responsible for ensuring that your use of AI supplements rather than replaces your own learning. Ultimately, you—not the AI—will be responsible for demonstrating your understanding on exams and other individual assessments.

AI Wearables: AI-enabled wearable devices are strictly prohibited in class.

All Other Guidelines:

Students are expected to follow all the standards of conduct, procedures, and policies as set forth by the [Student Handbook](#) and [Academic Bulletin](#).